Homework 3

Module 3 - Intravenous Infusions · Homework · No date

Name _____ Date _____

An antibiotic with a clearance of 5.775 L/hr and an apparent volume of distribution of approximately 25 L is to be administered by IV infusion to attain a steady-state plasma concentration of 20 mcg/mL.

a What is an appropriate rate of infusion to achieve the desired steady-state concentration of 20 mcg/mL?

b What is the half-life of the drug that is to be infused?

c What is the expected concentration of drug in the plasma 6 hours after the start of the infusion?

d How much time is required to reach 95% of the steady-state concentration if no loading dose were used?

e Recommend a loading dose to obtain the steady-state concentration immediately.

f If the infusion were stopped after the desired steady-state concentration of 20 mcg/mL was attained, what would the concentration be 8 hours after the cessation?

g If the infusion rate that you recommended in a (above) were doubled, what would the new steady-state concentration be?

h If the infusion rate that you recommended in a (above) were doubled, how long would it take to reach 95% of the new steady-state concentration (no loading dose)?

i If the infusion were stopped after proceeding long enough at the rate determined in part g (above) to reach the new steady-state concentration, what would the concentration be 6 hours after the cessation?

j What specific change would you make to achieve a steady state concentration of 12 mg/L?

Solutions

Her key: the answer and working on her own solved sheet or annotated slide. Worked by the drill: the drill's own working.

a

Worked by the drill

Answer: 115.5 mg/hr

WHAT THE STEM GIVES

Cl	5.775 L/hr	multiplied by C_{ss}
V_D	approximately 25 L	*not needed: the rate at steady state needs clearance only*
C_{ss}	20 mcg/mL	written 20 mg/L, multiplied by clearance

THE WORKING, ONE LINE AT A TIME

SETUP

$$R = C_{ss} \times Cl = (20\ mg/L)(5.775\ L/hr) = 115.50\ mg/hr$$

At steady state the infusion rate R equals the rate of elimination, Cl × C_{ss}, where Cl is clearance and C_{ss} the steady-state concentration; $C_{ss} = \frac{R}{Cl}$ rearranges to $R = C_{ss} \times Cl$. 20 mcg/mL is 20 mg/L, and (mg/L)(L/hr) cancels the litres, leaving mg/hr: (20 mg/L)(5.775 L/hr) = 115.50 mg/hr.

> **DOES THE NUMBER MAKE SENSE?**
>
> Each hour 5.775 L of plasma is cleared; keeping 20 mg in each litre needs 20 × 5.775 = 115.50 mg/hr, 20 times the clearance. The rate is above zero.

Her homework with her own numbers. She gave no key for it, so this answer is computed from her stem.

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b

Worked by the drill

Answer: 3 hr

WHAT THE STEM GIVES

Cl	5.775 L/hr	the numerator of $k = \frac{Cl}{V_D} = 0.231\ hr^{-1}$
V_D	approximately 25 L	the denominator of k
C_{ss}	20 mcg/mL	*not needed: half-life is a property of the drug and patient*

THE WORKING, ONE LINE AT A TIME

SETUP

$$k = \frac{Cl}{V_D} = \frac{5.775\ L/hr}{25\ L} = 0.231\ hr^{-1}$$

Clearance equals k times the volume, so dividing clearance by volume gives the rate constant in reciprocal hours.

ALGEBRA

$$t½ = \frac{0.693}{0.231\ hr^{-1}} = 3.00\ hr$$

$t½ = \frac{0.693}{k}$, because $k\ t½ = \ln 2$ when the concentration falls to half; with $k = 0.231\ hr^{-1}$ the reciprocal hours invert to hours, 3.00 hr. Elimination is a property of the drug and the patient, so an infusion does not change k or the half-life; it only sets the level reached.

> **DOES THE NUMBER MAKE SENSE?**
>
> $k = \frac{5.775}{25} = 0.231\ hr^{-1}$ removes about a fifth of the drug an hour, so halving takes about 3 hours: 3.00 hr.

Her homework with her own numbers. She gave no key for it, so this answer is computed from her stem.

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c Worked by the drill

Answer: 15 mg/L

WHAT THE STEM GIVES

Cl	5.775 L/hr	gave $k = 0.231\ hr^{-1}$ in part b, the exponent
V_D	approximately 25 L	the denominator of k
C_{ss}	20 mcg/mL	the plateau R over Cl = 20 mg/L the fraction is applied to
t	6 hours after the start	t in $1 - e^{-kt}$

THE WORKING, ONE LINE AT A TIME

SETUP

$$C = \frac{R}{Cl}(1 - e^{-kt}) = 20\ mg/L \times (1 - e^{-(0.231)(6)})$$

During a constant infusion the concentration is $C = \frac{R}{Cl}(1 - e^{-kt})$; R over Cl is the plateau C_{ss}, here 20 mg/L, and $(1 - e^{-kt})$ is the fraction of it reached by time t, because elimination has not yet grown to balance the input. $k = 0.231\ hr^{-1}$ from part b.

ALGEBRA

$$C = 20\ mg/L \times (1 - 0.2501) = 15.00\ mg/L$$

$kt = (0.231\ hr^{-1})(6\ hr) = 1.386$, a pure number, and $e^{-1.386} = 0.2501$ is the fraction of C_{ss} still missing; $1 - 0.2501 = 0.7499$ has been reached. Six hours is 2.00 half-lives of 3.00 hr, so the level is $20 \times 0.7499 = 15.00$ mg/L.

> **DOES THE NUMBER MAKE SENSE?**
>
> Six hours is two half-lives of 3.00 hr: after one half-life 50% of the plateau is reached, after two 75%, so the level is three-quarters of 20: 15.00 mg/L, below 20.

Her homework with her own numbers. She gave no key for it, so this answer is computed from her stem.

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d

Worked by the drill

Answer: 12.97 hr

WHAT THE STEM GIVES

Cl	5.775 L/hr	gave k = 0.231 hr^{-1} in part b, the denominator
V_D	approximately 25 L	the denominator of k
C_{ss}	20 mcg/mL	*not needed: the fraction 0.95 is dimensionless*
fraction	95%	sets $e^{-kt} = 0.05$, so kt = ln(20) = 2.9957

THE WORKING, ONE LINE AT A TIME

SETUP

$$0.95 = 1 - e^{-kt} \rightarrow e^{-kt} = 0.05 \rightarrow t = \frac{\ln(20)}{k}$$

The fraction of C_{ss} reached during an infusion is $\frac{C}{C_{ss}} = 1 - e^{-kt}$, which depends only on kt. Setting it to 0.95 gives $e^{-kt} = 0.05$, so $kt = -\ln 0.05 = \ln 20 = 2.9957$ and $t = \frac{\ln(20)}{k}$; the infusion rate R cancels and plays no part.

ALGEBRA

$$t = \frac{2.9957}{0.231\ hr^{-1}} = 12.97\ hr\ (4.32\ half\text{-}lives)$$

ln 20 = 2.9957 is a pure number, so dividing by k = 0.231 hr^{-1} leaves hours: 12.97 hr. Because $k = \frac{0.693}{t½}$, the same time is $\frac{2.9957}{0.693}$ = 4.32 half-lives of the 3.00 hr from part b; without a loading dose, 95% of C_{ss} takes 4.32 half-lives at any infusion rate.

> **DOES THE NUMBER MAKE SENSE?**
> Each half-life closes half the remaining gap: 50, 75, 87.5, about 94% after four, so 95% needs a little more than four half-lives: 4.32 × t½ = 12.97 hr, between 4 and 5 half-lives.

Her homework with her own numbers. She gave no key for it, so this answer is computed from her stem.

e

Worked by the drill

Answer: 500 mg

WHAT THE STEM GIVES

Cl	5.775 L/hr	*not needed: a loading dose fills the volume; clearance sets the rate*
V_D	approximately 25 L	multiplied by C_{ss}
C_{ss}	20 mcg/mL	written 20 mg/L, multiplied by V_D

THE WORKING, ONE LINE AT A TIME

SETUP

$D_L = C_{ss} \times V_D = (20\ \text{mg/L})(25\ \text{L}) = 500\ \text{mg}$

The loading dose puts the steady-state amount in the body at once: concentration times volume gives an amount.

> **DOES THE NUMBER MAKE SENSE?**
> To have 20 mg in each of 25 litres at once takes 20 × 25 = 500 mg. The dose is above zero.

Her homework with her own numbers. She gave no key for it, so this answer is computed from her stem.

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f

Worked by the drill

Answer: 3.15 mg/L

WHAT THE STEM GIVES

Cl	5.775 L/hr	gave k = 0.231 hr^{-1} in part b, the exponent
V_D	approximately 25 L	the denominator of k
C_{ss}	20 mcg/mL	the level the decay starts from
t	8 hours after the cessation	t in e^{-kt}

THE WORKING, ONE LINE AT A TIME

SETUP

$C = C_{ss}\, e^{-kt} = 20\ \text{mg/L} \times e^{-(0.231)(8)}$

Once the infusion stops nothing more goes in, so the plasma level follows the one-compartment decline $C = C_0\, e^{-kt}$ with the concentration at the moment of stopping, C_{ss} = 20 mg/L, as the starting point; k = 0.231 hr^{-1} from part b and t = 8 hr counted from the cessation.

ALGEBRA

$C = 20 \times 0.1576 = 3.15\ \text{mg/L}$

kt = (0.231 hr^{-1})(8 hr) = 1.848, a pure number, and $e^{-1.848}$ = 0.1576 is the fraction of C_{ss} remaining: 20 × 0.1576 = 3.15 mg/L. Eight hours is 2.67 half-lives of 3.00 hr, so between an eighth and a quarter of C_{ss} is left.

> **DOES THE NUMBER MAKE SENSE?**
> Eight hours is between two and three half-lives of 3.00 hr, so between an eighth and a quarter of 20 mg/L remains: 3.15 mg/L, between 0.125 × 20 and 0.25 × 20.

Her homework with her own numbers. She gave no key for it, so this answer is computed from her stem.

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g

Worked by the drill

Answer: 40 mg/L

WHAT THE STEM GIVES

Cl	5.775 L/hr	the denominator, unchanged
V_D	approximately 25 L	*not needed: C_{ss} depends on rate and clearance only*

C_{ss}	20 mcg/mL	the plateau at the original rate; doubles with the rate
R	doubled	2R = 231.00 mg/hr, the numerator

THE WORKING, ONE LINE AT A TIME

SETUP

$$C_{ss} = \frac{2R}{Cl} = \frac{231.00 \text{ mg/hr}}{5.775 \text{ L/hr}} = 40 \text{ mg/L}$$

$C_{ss} = \frac{R}{Cl}$: at steady state the input R equals the elimination Cl × C_{ss}, so the plateau is proportional to the rate at a fixed clearance. Doubling R from 115.50 to 231.00 mg/hr with Cl still 5.775 L/hr doubles C_{ss} from 20 to 40 mg/L; the litres per hour cancel to leave mg/L.

> **DOES THE NUMBER MAKE SENSE?**
> C_{ss} is proportional to the rate at a fixed clearance, so doubling R doubles the plateau from 20 to 40 mg/L; the time to reach it does not change.

Her homework with her own numbers. She gave no key for it, so this answer is computed from her stem.

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h

Worked by the drill

Answer: 12.97 hr

WHAT THE STEM GIVES

Cl	5.775 L/hr	gave k = 0.231 hr^{-1} in part b, the denominator of ln(20) over k
V_D	approximately 25 L	the denominator of k
C_{ss}	20 mcg/mL	*not needed: R cancels out of the fraction reached*
R	doubled	*not needed: the time to a fraction of steady state depends on k alone*
fraction	95%	sets kt = ln(20)

THE WORKING, ONE LINE AT A TIME

SETUP

$$t = \frac{\ln(20)}{k} = 12.97 \text{ hr, the same as part d}$$

The time to a fraction of steady state depends only on k, so a faster rate reaches a higher plateau in the same time.

> **DOES THE NUMBER MAKE SENSE?**
> The fraction of the plateau reached is $1 - e^{-kt}$, with no R in it, so the doubled rate reaches 95% of its higher plateau in the same number of half-lives: 12.97 hr, as in part d.

Her homework with her own numbers. She gave no key for it, so this answer is computed from her stem.

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i

Worked by the drill

Answer: 10 mg/L

WHAT THE STEM GIVES

Cl	5.775 L/hr	gave k = 0.231 hr^{-1} in part b, the exponent
V_D	approximately 25 L	the denominator of k
C_{ss}	20 mcg/mL	doubled in part g to 40 mg/L, the level the decay starts from
t	6 hours after the cessation	t in e^{-kt}

THE WORKING, ONE LINE AT A TIME

SETUP

$C = (40\ mg/L)\ e^{-(0.231)(6)} = 40 \times 0.2501 = 10.00\ mg/L$

After the infusion stops the level follows $C = C_0\ e^{-kt}$ from the concentration at cessation, the new plateau of 40 mg/L from part g. k = 0.231 hr^{-1} is unchanged, so kt = 1.386 and $e^{-1.386}$ = 0.2501 of the plateau remains: 40 × 0.2501 = 10.00 mg/L.

> **DOES THE NUMBER MAKE SENSE?**
> Six hours is two half-lives of 3.00 hr, so a quarter of the 40 mg/L plateau remains: 0.25 × 40 = 10.00 mg/L.

Her homework with her own numbers. She gave no key for it, so this answer is computed from her stem.

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j

Worked by the drill

Answer: 69.3 mg/hr

WHAT THE STEM GIVES

Cl	5.775 L/hr	multiplied by the new target
V_D	approximately 25 L	*not needed: the rate at steady state needs clearance only*
C_{ss}	20 mcg/mL	the old target, replaced by 12 mg/L
new C_{ss}	12 mg/L	multiplied by clearance

THE WORKING, ONE LINE AT A TIME

SETUP

Change the infusion rate: $R = C_{ss} \times Cl = (12\ mg/L)(5.775\ L/hr) = 69.30\ mg/hr$

$C_{ss} = \frac{R}{Cl}$, and Cl, the clearance, is a property of the patient that cannot be prescribed, so the infusion rate R is the variable to change. For C_{ss} = 12 mg/L, $R = C_{ss} \times Cl$ = (12 mg/L)(5.775 L/hr) = 69.30 mg/hr, the litres cancelling; the rate falls from 115.50 mg/hr.

> **DOES THE NUMBER MAKE SENSE?**
> The target drops from 20 to 12 mg/L, three-fifths of before, so the rate drops to three-fifths of the part a rate: 12 × 5.775 = 69.30 mg/hr, below it.

Her homework with her own numbers. She gave no key for it, so this answer is computed from her stem. Part j asks for a change; the number entered is the new infusion rate.
